The AI Governance RACI Starter

FREE asset	Tier 0	AI GOVERNANCE CHAIN™

Who is accountable for what. The organizational layer most frameworks skip, and the reason governance stalls.

Abbreviations and Acronyms

No prior knowledge is assumed. Every acronym used in this document is defined below.

AI: Artificial Intelligence

CAIO: Chief Artificial Intelligence Officer

RACI: Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed

The WHY

Governance fails not because the policy is wrong, but because no one owns it. A RACI (Responsible, Accountable, Consulted, Informed) chart turns "someone should handle this" into a named person.

The starter chart

Activity	Responsible	Accountable	Consulted	Informed
Maintain the AI inventory	Governance lead	CAIO or exec sponsor	System owners	Board
Classify risk tier	System owner	Governance lead	Legal, compliance	CAIO
Approve high-risk launch	Review board	CAIO	Legal, security	Board
Monitor in production	System owner	Governance lead	Engineering	CAIO
Respond to an incident	Incident lead	CAIO	Legal, comms	Board
Quarterly review	Governance lead	CAIO	All owners	Board

Accountable means one person, never a committee. Responsible can be several.

How to use it

Copy the chart, replace the role labels with real names, and circulate it. Gaps (an activity with no name) are your highest-priority risk.

Where free ends and paid begins

- - FREE (what and why): the starter chart and the one-accountable-person rule.
- - PAID (with-you): the full governance operating model, role descriptions, and committee charters in the AI Governance Operating System (Tier C) and the Pre-Scale Audit.

AI GOVERNANCE CHAIN™

AI Governance Framework

(c) 2026 Mathieu K. Gouanou. All rights reserved.

A member of the Harvard Business Review Advisory Council, an opt-in research community of business professionals.

Document standard: human-first AI governance.